I need to prepare and deliver a sermon – what does MyBible have to assist?

mybible.zone/android/how-to/sermon

⬆ All “How to” articles

You should be aware that a complete replacement of the printed paper Bible, especially for those who preach, is a declared non-goal of the MyBible project. That being noted, MyBible does have means to help in preparing and delivering a sermon.

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Preparing of a sermon

First of all, decide for yourself whether you want to use MyBible for actual capturing of your sermon’s points or just for finding, analyzing, assessing the biblical material.

Finding and assessing biblical material

Study what the article “How can MyBible help me study a difficult Bible fragment?” has to say.

The Bible text search functionality is powerful. Its limitation to be remembered is that it cannot find other forms of a specified full word, so it is recommended to base your search on unchangeable roots of sought phrase’s keywords.

Just to hint you on the special powers of the search functionality in the context of preparing a sermon:

- allows you to search in the marked words of Jesus
- allows to find a combination of words even if the sought words are not in the same verse (you can specify how many verses apart they can be)

Capturing sermon's points as notes

Capturing your thought in notes allows you to build material for your message as a continuos text, including texts of referenced Bible verses or containing just hyperlinks to them.

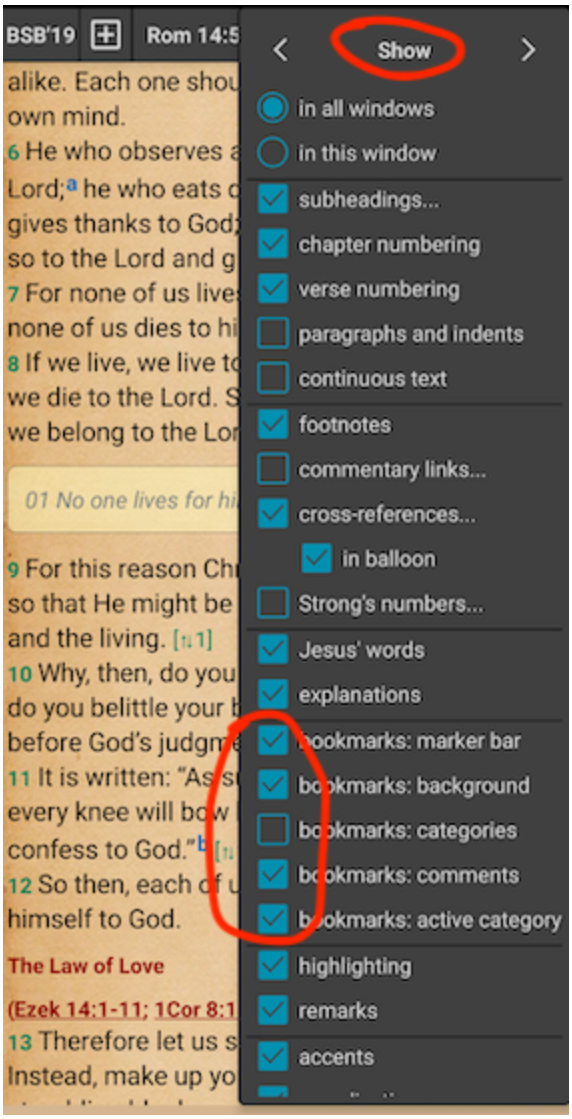
Capturing sermon/message points as bookmarks

Bookmarks in MyBible are grouped into colored categories and are a rather powerful tool. Since a bookmark can have a comment, and bookmark comments can be shown in the Bible text, capturing your sermon points using bookmarks may be a viable option – this approach even prompts for a better focusing on the Bible text itself rather than on your comments.

A suggested way of capturing a sermon/message points in bookmarks is:

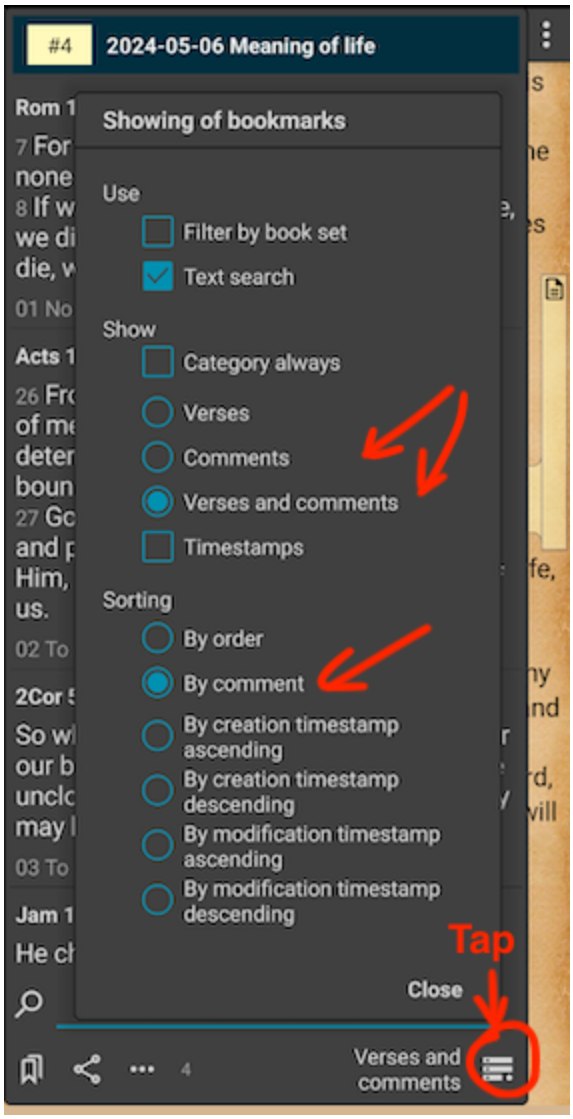
- have a dedicated bookmarks category for a particular sermon/message
- start a bokmark comment with two digits: "01", "02", … "25", so that you can have them the bookmarks sorted by comment in the desired order of discussing
- use the bookmarks side panel to navigate between your bookmarks

Here are the recommented bookmark-related settings in the "Show" sub-menu:



The “bookmark: active category” setting is destined exactly for this, so that you only see bookmarks from the bookmark category dedicated to your sermon/message – and not the other ones you might have for the Bible places being discussed.

Here are the bookmark side panel settings:



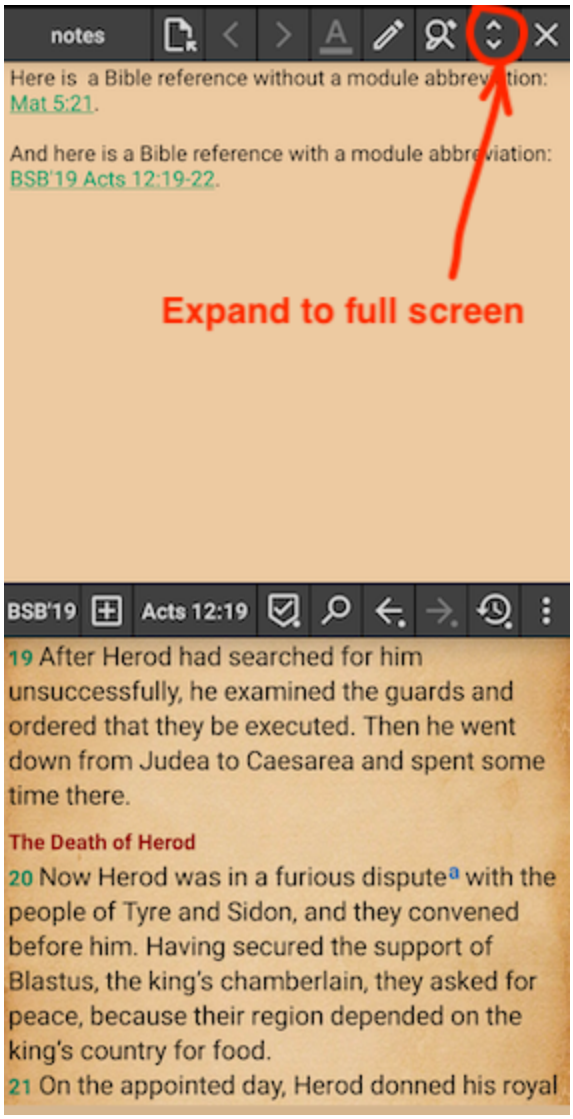
Sorting “by comment” allows you to control the order of your bookmarks in the side panel.

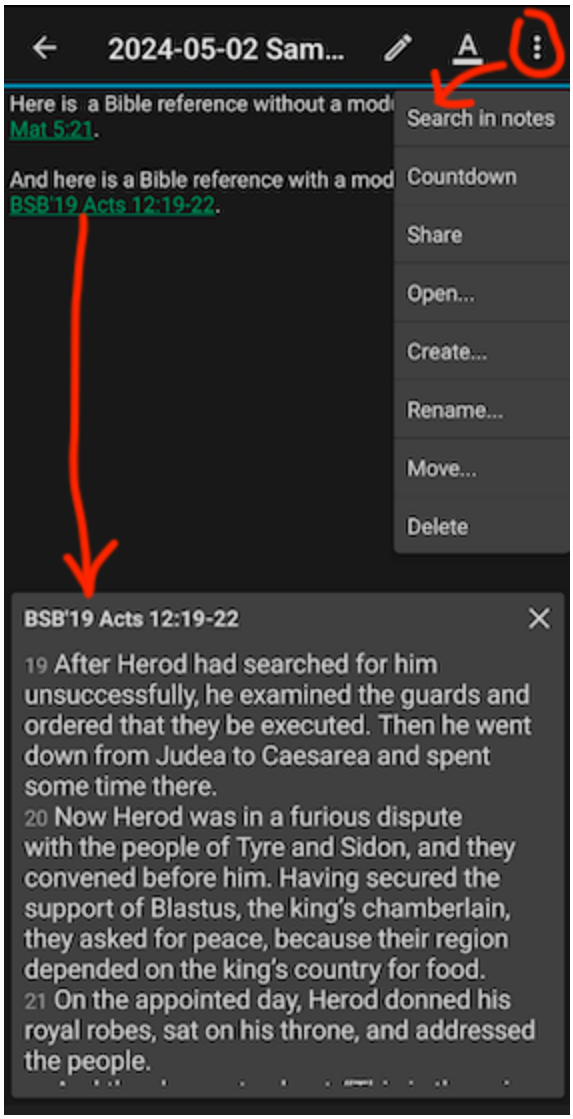
Delivering of a sermon

Notes window

If you have captured material for your sermon as MyBible notes, you definitely want to deactivate the “Allow editing” mode – not only to preserve your notes from an accidental corruption or deletion but also to turn Bible references into hyperlinks.

Also, remember the notes full screen mode:

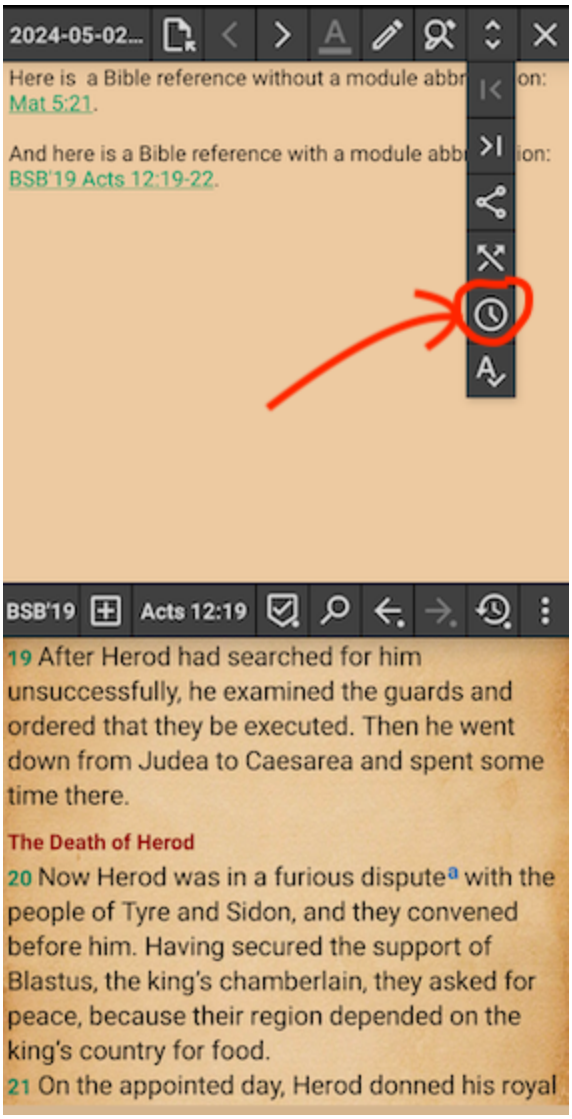

notes
Here is a Bible reference without a module abbreviation:
Mat 5:21.
And here is a Bible reference with a module abbreviation:
BSB'19 Acts 12:19-22.
Expand to full screen
BSB'19
Acts 12:19
19 After Herod had searched for him unsuccessfully, he examined the guards and ordered that they be executed. Then he went down from Judea to Caesarea and spent some time there.
The Death of Herod
20 Now Herod was in a furious dispute[a] with the people of Tyre and Sidon, and they convened before him. Having secured the support of Blastus, the king's chamberlain, they asked for peace, because their region depended on the king's country for food.
21 On the appointed day, Herod donned his royal



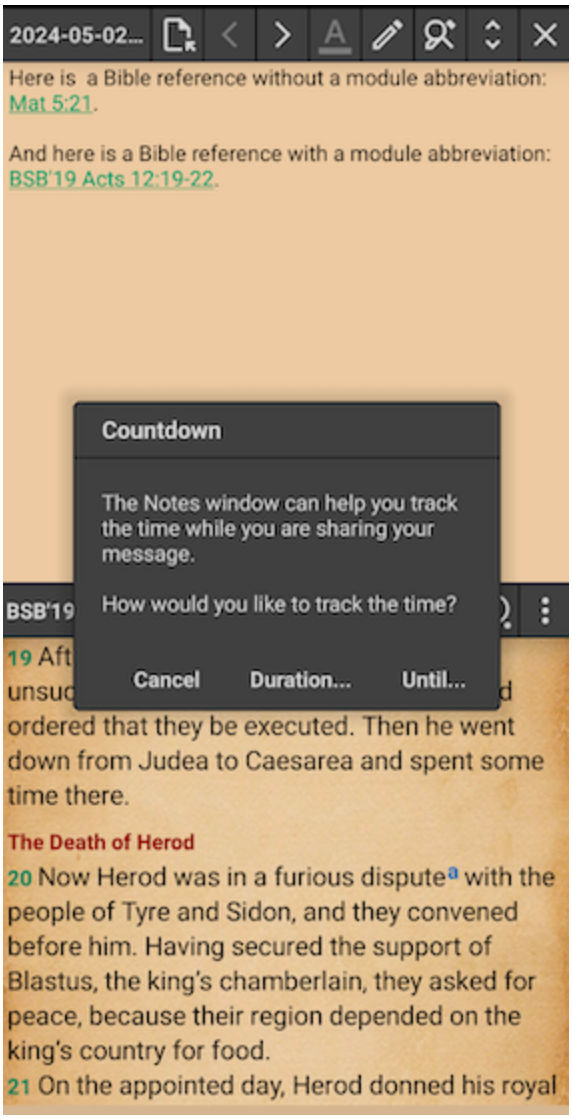
The full screen mode allows you to focus more on your notes than on the continuous text of the Bible you are basing your message on. While in the normal notes window a Bible hyperlink just proceeds to the Bible place your reference begins with, in the full screen notes window the whole reference affects the result, so that in the popup window at the bottom you see the entire referenced Bible fragment. Please be considerate when using this, as your referenced Bible fragment appears this way out of its immediate context – and the context is the king, as they say.

Different functions of the notes window in the full screen mode are menu items rather than header buttons.

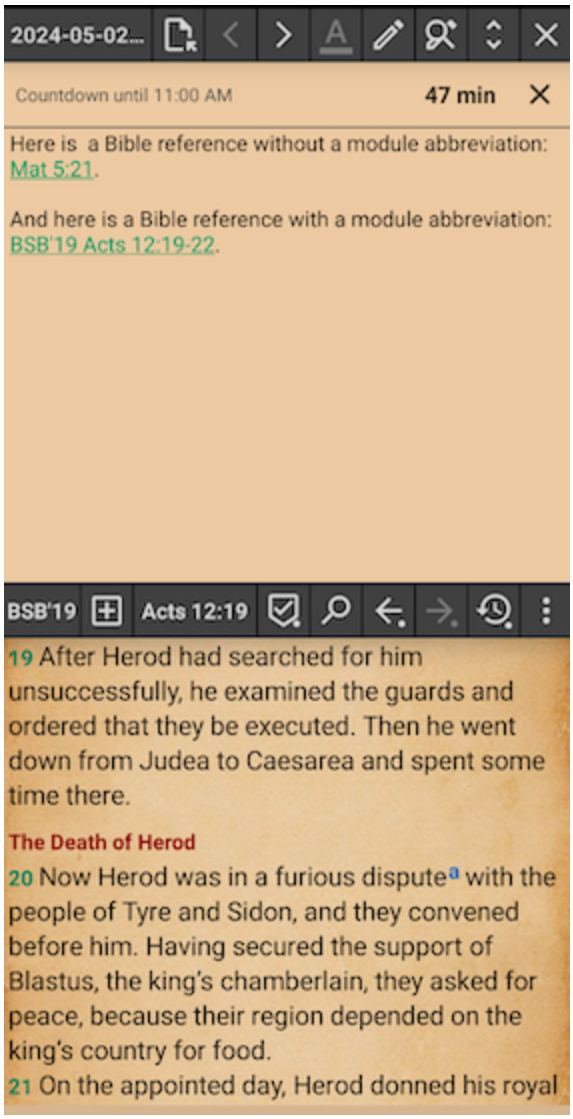
One other message delivering-related feature of the Bible window is the countdown – a function that will help you be responsible before your audience in the sense of keeping your allocated time slot. Here is the button activating the countown:



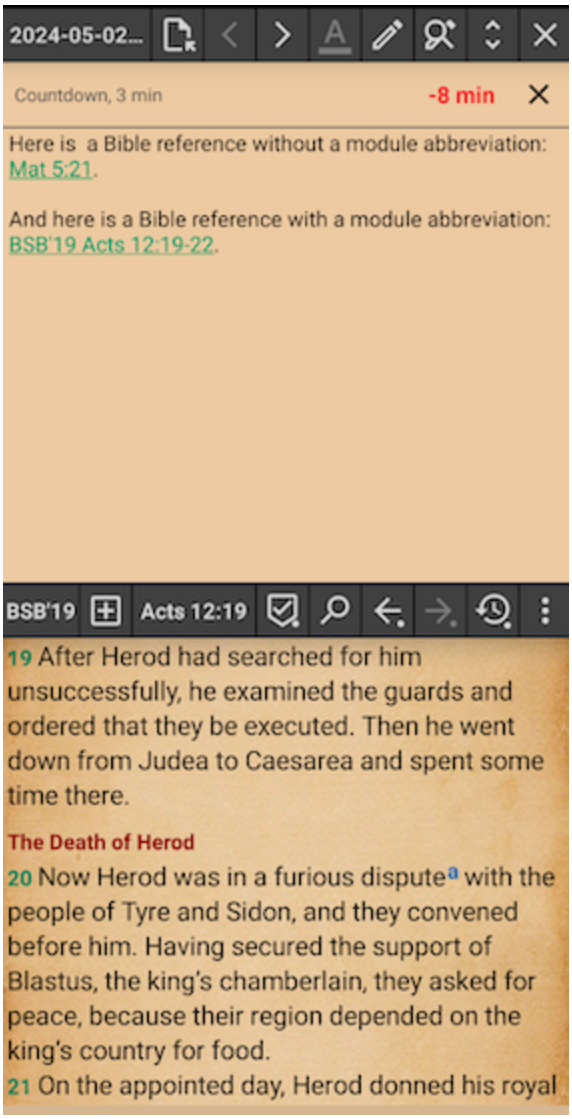
The two timing options are “Duration” and “Until”:



Here is how it looks like when the countown is active:



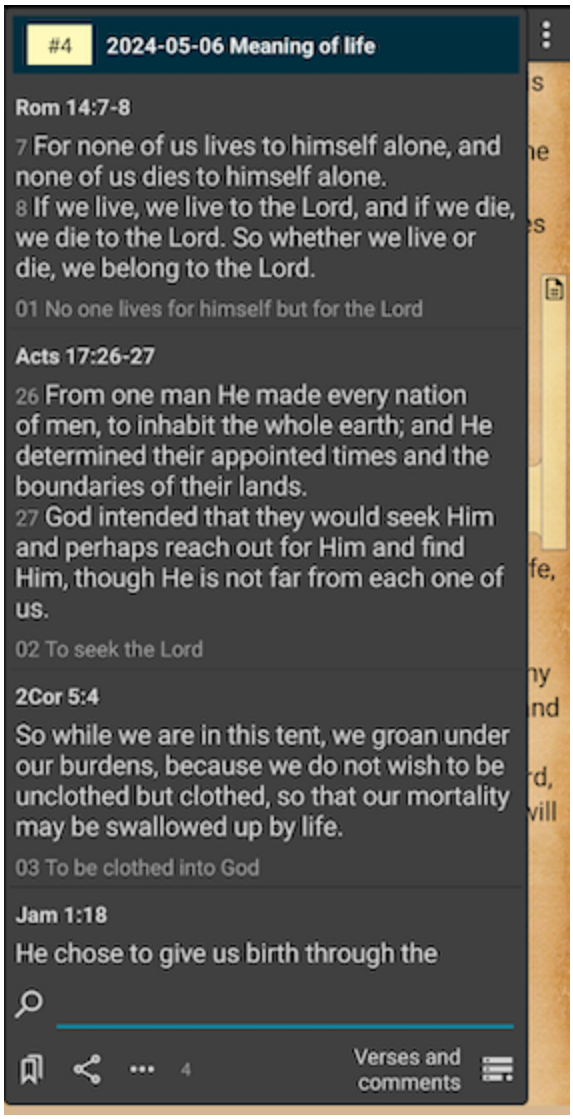
And here is how an exceeded countdown looks like:



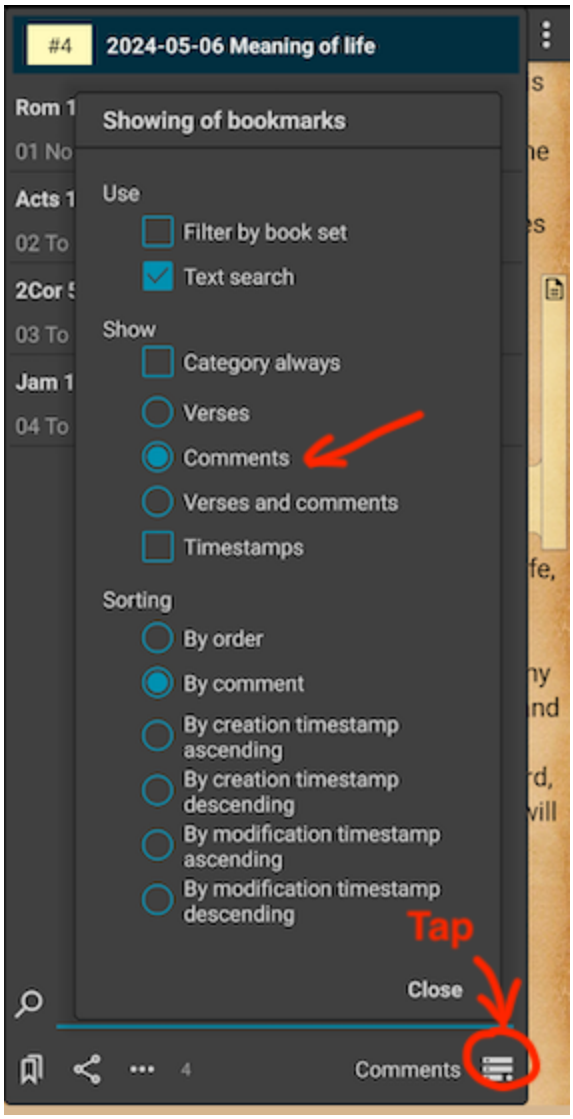
There are no sound or vibration ararm – just a friendly reminder of the time left or exceeded.

Bookmarks side panel

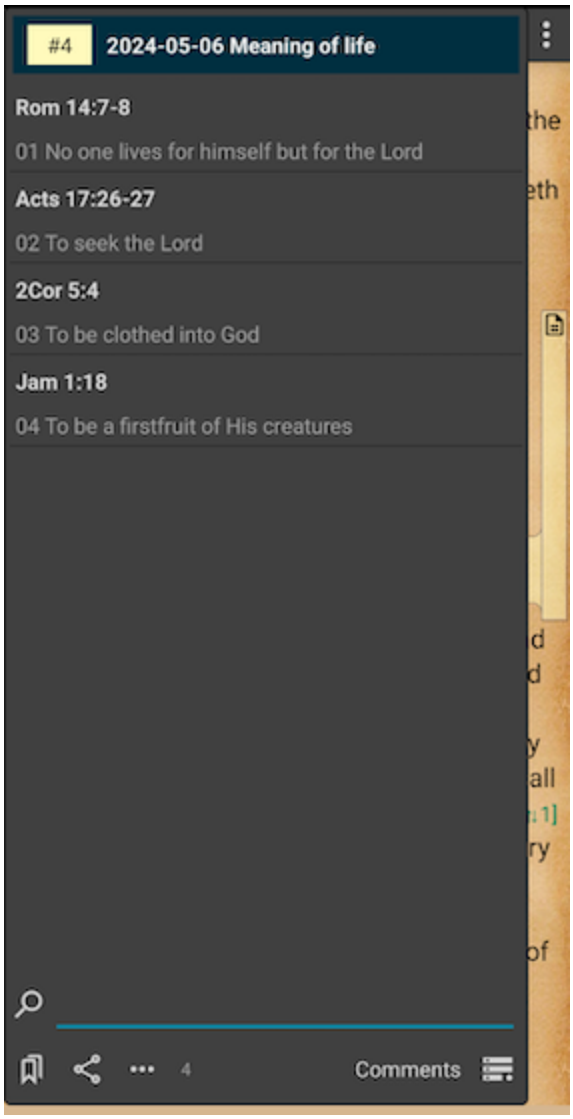
Once all your sermon/message points are captured as bookmarks in a dedicated bookmark category, your can just use the bookmark side panel to see both your commented points and the referenced Bible verses:



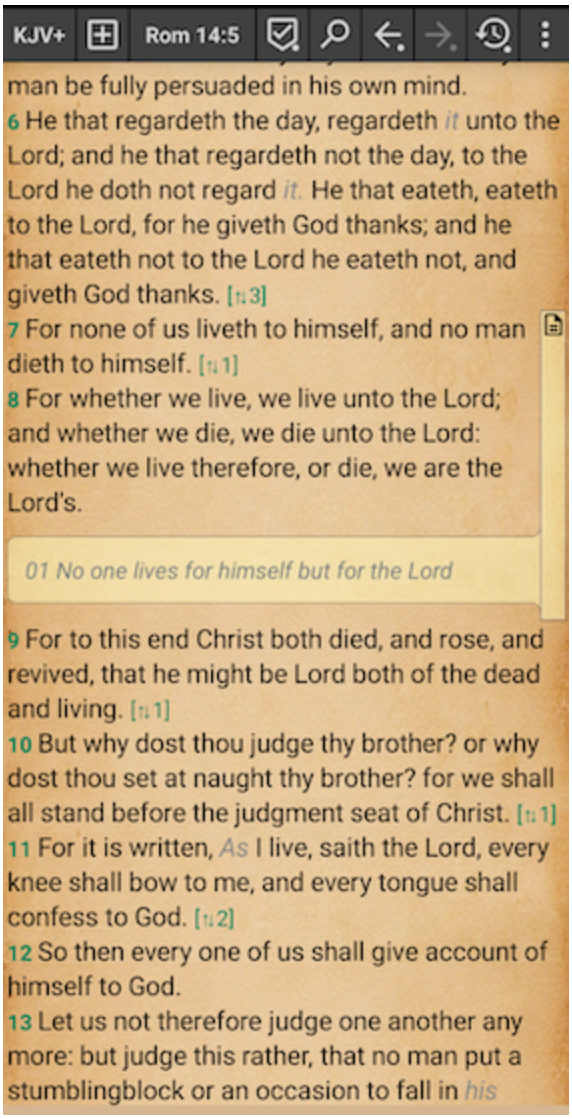
Or, you can select showing only bookmark comments in the bookmark side panel:



and then see only your ordered comments in the bookmarks side panel:



Tap a bookmark to proceed to the related Bible place, with the bookmark area indicated and the bookmark comment shown:


KJV+
Rom 14:5
man be fully persuaded in his own mind.
6 He that regardeth the day, regardeth it unto the Lord; and he that regardeth not the day, to the Lord he doth not regard it. He that eateth, eateth to the Lord, for he giveth God thanks; and he that eateth not to the Lord he eateth not, and giveth God thanks. [↑↓3]
7 For none of us liveth to himself, and no man dieth to himself. [↑↓1]
8 For whether we live, we live unto the Lord; and whether we die, we die unto the Lord: whether we live therefore, or die, we are the Lord's.
01 No one lives for himself but for the Lord
9 For to this end Christ both died, and rose, and revived, that he might be Lord both of the dead and living. [↑↓1]
10 But why dost thou judge thy brother? or why dost thou set at naught thy brother? for we shall all stand before the judgment seat of Christ. [↑↓1]
11 For it is written, As I live, saith the Lord, every knee shall bow to me, and every tongue shall confess to God. [↑↓2]
12 So then every one of us shall give account of himself to God.
13 Let us not therefore judge one another any more: but judge this rather, that no man put a stumblingblock or an occasion to fall in his